Project Report

Digital Literacy

Course	CSE0001 - Digital Literacy
Name	Mohit Borekar
Registration No.	25BGC10008
Branch	Computer Science & Engineering (Gaming Technology)
Year	First Year B.Tech (2025-2029)
Date	March 28, 2026

INTRODUCTION

At VIT Bhopal, I have been appointed as a Student Digital Ambassador. The primary responsibility of this appointment is to provide guidance to my fellow students in the effective use of the internet, which includes assistance with creating an online professional profile and staying safe from cybercrime; therefore, the purpose of this report is to document my participation in five different modules of the Student Digital Ambassador program. The modules included creating an infographic, creating my professional portfolio, coding and collaboration, email etiquette, and researching online safety; through this work, I have created a digital portfolio of my skills and commitment to being a responsible member of the digital community.

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Student Digital Portfolio

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INTRODUCTION

For this task, I established a foundational digital presence by setting up and updating profiles on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**. I chose these platforms because they are the primary tools used by the global tech community to track skills and professional growth. On GitHub, I created a profile README to introduce myself as a Gaming Technology student, ensuring my branch and learning goals are visible to anyone visiting my profile. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my current B.Tech degree at VIT Bhopal.

Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a live archive of my progress. I will use GitHub to host my coding projects and version control my game development scripts, while Kaggle will help me explore the data-driven side of AI. LinkedIn will serve as my main networking hub for finding internships and connecting with industry professionals in the gaming sector. Setting these up now ensures that by the time I graduate in 2029, I will have a comprehensive, professional history that proves my technical abilities and consistency.

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Digital Literacy Essentials

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INTRODUCTION

For this module, I explored technical practice and digital collaboration using **HackerRank** and **Google Workspace**. On HackerRank, I completed a beginner Python challenge to strengthen my foundational logic, which is essential for my studies in Computer Science. This platform demonstrated how gamified learning and immediate feedback can help a student track their technical progress.

In addition to coding, I developed a five-question **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using Google Forms to engage my peers as a Digital Ambassador. I included a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions to cover topics like safe browsing and professional profile management. I also set up a linked Google Sheet to monitor responses, which highlighted the efficiency of cloud-based collaboration tools. Academically, mastering these tools allows me to coordinate group projects at **VIT Bhopal** more effectively and manage data systematically. This task reinforced that being digitally literate means not only writing code but also knowing how to use collaborative platforms to communicate and gather information.

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Professional Communication & Etiquette

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Objective

As a **Student Digital Ambassador**, my objective for this module was to demonstrate effective digital communication and develop a guide for responsible social media use within the **VIT Bhopal** community. This involved mastering the "digital handshake"—the professional tone required for academic and career-related interactions.

Professional Email Drafts

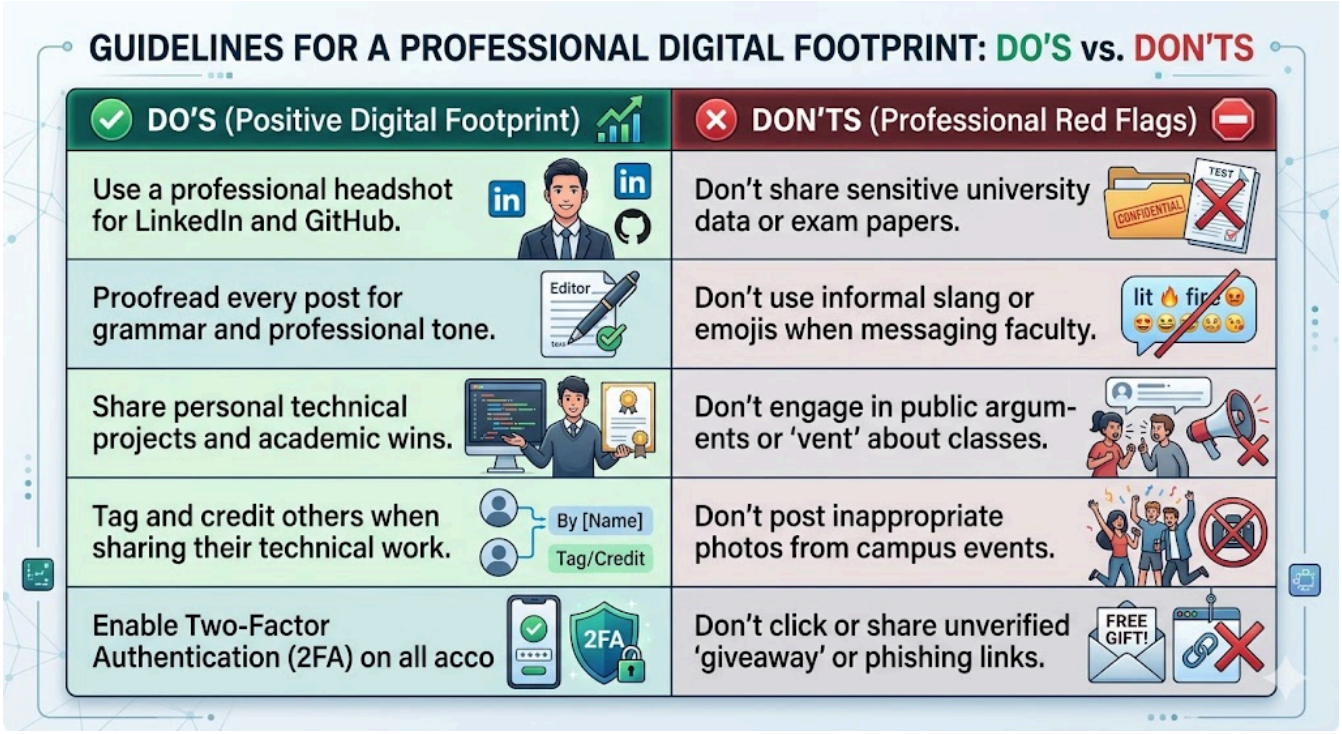
I developed two formal email templates to handle common student scenarios:

- **Email 1: Assignment Extension Request**
  - **Subject:** Extension Request Mohit Borekar (25BGC10008).

- **Context:** This draft addresses a situation where technical difficulties, such as weak hostel Wi-Fi, prevent a timely submission. It uses a respectful tone and provides a specific new deadline.

- **Email 2: Internship Inquiry**
  - **Subject:** Internship Inquiry: Summer 2026 Mohit Borekar (25BGC10008).
  - **Context:** Targeted at industry coordinators, this email highlights my specialization in **Gaming Technology** and references my technical projects, such as the Python-based Tic-Tac-Toe game, to build professional credibility.

Social Media Etiquette Checklist



Reflection

As a Student Digital Ambassador, I have observed that many communication challenges arise from a lack of clear context. A common scenario is when students send informal messages to faculty without subject lines or registration details, leading to unnecessary delays and confusion. Drafting these formal emails taught me that professional etiquette is about providing the

recipient with all necessary information to help you effectively. For example, in my extension request, citing weak hostel Wi-Fi provided a grounded, realistic reason for the delay. Furthermore, the internship inquiry allowed me to showcase my technical identity, specifically my specialization in **Gaming Technology** and my Python projects. Moving forward, I realize that a professional "digital handshake" is the first step toward building credibility and ensuring my academic and professional requests are handled successfully.

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Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

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Case Study:
UPI Spoofing and QR Code Scams

In my research as a Student Digital Ambassador, I focused on **UPI Spoofing**, a rapidly growing threat in 2026. Scammers use fraudulent applications that mimic the user interface of popular UPI wallets (like GPay or PhonePe) to show a fake "Payment Successful" screen. This trick is often used against students selling items online or local vendors. Another common tactic is the **QR Code Scam**, where victims are tricked into scanning a code to "receive" money, but in reality, scanning and entering a PIN only *authorizes a deduction* from their own account.

8-Tip Prevention Checklist

To protect yourself and your classmates from these financial threats, follow these essential safety rules:

1. **PIN is only for Sending:** Never enter your UPI PIN or scan a QR code to *receive* money.
2. **Verify the Recipient:** Always double-check the name displayed on your app screen before hitting 'Pay'.
3. **Use Official Apps Only:** Never download "screen-sharing" or "remote access" apps (like AnyDesk) on the instructions of a stranger.
4. **Check Bank SMS:** Confirm that money has actually been credited via your bank's official SMS or app, not just by looking at a sender's screenshot.
5. **Decline 'Collect' Requests:** Be wary of unexpected notifications asking you to "Approve" a payment request.
6. **Secure Your Device:** Use biometric locks and Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) for all financial and social media accounts.
7. **Limit Daily Transactions:** Set a sensible daily limit on your UPI app to minimize potential losses if a breach occurs.
8. **Report Immediately:** If fraud occurs, call the **National Cybercrime Helpline at 1930** or visit **cybercrime.gov.in** within the "Golden Hour" to freeze the transaction.
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Reflection

Reflection

Researching UPI fraud was a significant eye-opener for me. As a Computer Science student specializing in **Gaming Technology**, I considered myself tech-savvy, but I realized how sophisticated social engineering has become in 2026. Scammers don't just use technical glitches; they exploit a student's sense of urgency or lack of experience with digital payments.

One major habit I am changing is my level of caution when scanning QR codes in public spaces or while using online marketplaces. I've also shared the **1930 helpline** details with my hostel batchmates,

as many were unaware of the "Golden Hour" for reporting fraud. This task reinforced that being a Digital Ambassador isn't just about building profiles; it’s about maintaining the vigilance required to protect our financial identities. Digital literacy is our first and strongest line of defense against these evolving threats.